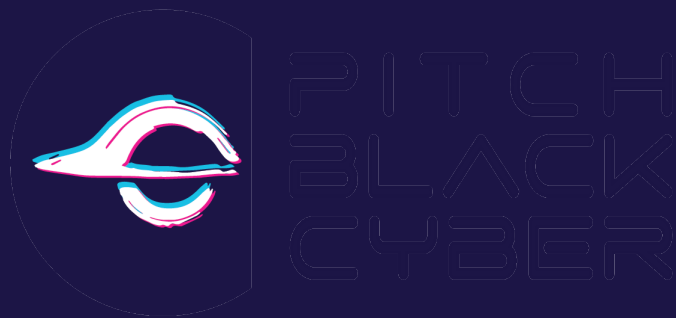




The 2026 Ransomware Protection Checklist

10 Practical Steps to Harden Your Defenses

Practical cybersecurity for real-world business needs.

Ransomware attacks against small and medium businesses are up 400% this year. Threat actors are aggressively targeting organizations that lack complex enterprise defenses. We built this 10-point actionable checklist to help you identify critical vulnerabilities, secure your remote workforce, and establish resilient, tested backups—before you become a statistic.

Use this plain-English guide to evaluate your current security posture and identify clear next steps for protection.

I Identify Critical Vulnerabilities

- 1 Find Your Weak Spots**
Regularly check your computers, websites, and networks for "open doors" that hackers could walk through.
- 2 Keep Everything Updated Automatically**
Turn on auto-updates for your computers, phones, and software (like web browsers and PDF readers) to quickly fix known security holes.
- 3 Upgrade to "Next-Gen" Antivirus**
Traditional antivirus isn't enough anymore. Use modern security software that watches for weird behavior and stops attacks in real-time before they spread.

I Secure Your Remote Workforce

- 4 Require Two-Step Logins (MFA)**
Always require a second proof of identity (like a code on your phone) to log into company email, cloud apps, and remote connections. This stops hackers even if they guess your password.
- 5 Lock Down Remote Work**
Never let employees connect directly to office computers from the internet without using a secure, private, and monitored connection.
- 6 Use a Business Password Manager**
Stop people from reusing weak passwords or sharing them on sticky notes. Give your team a secure app to store and create strong passwords for them.
- 7 Train Your Team to Spot Scams**
Teach your staff how to recognize tricky email scams. Create a safe culture where they feel comfortable reporting a mistake immediately if they accidentally click a bad link.

| Establish Resilient Backups & Response

8 Create "Ransomware-Proof" Backups

Set up backups that are "read-only" so hackers cannot delete or scramble them. Keep a copy completely disconnected from your main network.

9 Practice Getting Your Data Back

A backup is useless if it doesn't work when you need it. Run practice drills to prove you can actually recover your files quickly.

10 Write Down an Emergency Game Plan

Create a simple, printed list of exactly who to call, what to unplug, and how to contact your cyber insurance provider if the worst happens.

Ready to strengthen your security posture?

We help turn cybersecurity complexity into clear next steps. Whether you need a readiness assessment, remediation guidance, or compliance planning, Pitch Black Cyber is your trusted partner.

Clear findings. Practical fixes. Stronger security.

Book your readiness assessment today at pitchblackcyber.com